

A Cantor Space of Surreal Subfields

Finite supports, universal embeddings,
and two generic regimes

Research article prepared for Vladimir Reshetnikov

AI-assisted mathematical draft

3 October 2026

Abstract

We construct an explicit countable real-closed subfield K^* of the surreal numbers and a closed Cantor family of elementary subfields of K^* . Every ambient element has a unique finite support in a fixed transcendence basis. Consequently, varying a subfield is topologically as simple as choosing a subset of a countable set. Nevertheless, field embeddability on this compact family is a complete analytic quasiorder. A concrete coding uses $\omega^{b\omega^q}$, with $q \in \mathbb{Q}$ and $b \in \{1, \sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}, \dots\}$; the ordered additive groups of real quadratic fields intrinsically record countably many colors.

A rank-one subfamily admits an exact reduction to countable linear orders. Within it, a fixed field of reverse- ω value-group rank has an analytic-complete embedding locus, while every source of finite transcendence degree has an open locus. Almost every rank-one parameter, both in category and in coin-flip measure, gives the same isomorphism type. In the larger family, by contrast, the locus admitting the whole ambient field is also analytic-complete and dense, but meager and null. General category and measure zero-one laws explain the two regimes.

The unrestricted complexity of countable real-closed-field embeddability is already known. The contribution developed here is the explicit common surreal ambient field, compact finite-support localization, fixed-source threshold, and generic comparison. Full proofs of these refinements are given; historical priority is not certified, and no Lean verification is claimed.

Scope. Ordinary ordered fields, not exponential or differential fields. All descriptive-set-theoretic spaces are sets. No measurable structure on the proper class **No** is used.

[**write**] Filed in ProveIt's surreal report collection as `foundations-and-computation/cantor-families-of-surreal-subfields` (batch 90, manuscript 04; label prefix `csf:`). Provenance, formal status, the relation to neighbouring reports and a notation table are in Sections 1.4 and 1.5.

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1 Research intersection and the precise contribution

1.1 Why this topic connects the two research programs

Elliot Glazer’s *A Topological Tennenbaum Theorem* studies the tension between algebraic structure, definability, and Polish topology in models of arithmetic [1]. His work on FrontierMath concerns the evaluation of advanced mathematical reasoning [2]. These provide two relevant interests: descriptive obstructions to apparently simple mathematical presentations, and the difference between genuine structural difficulty and what a sampling procedure happens to reveal.

ProveIt has an explicit surreal-field development, real-closedness results, Hahn-series infrastructure, and research on self-embeddings and their valuation invariants [12, 13]. The present article moves from individual self-embeddings of **No** to a *space of countable elementary subfields of one field inside No*. This connects the valuation-based constructions with descriptive classification, without putting a Polish space structure on all surreal numbers.

There is an important change of level. Our Cantor topology is a topology on *parameters for fields*; it is not the order topology on the domain of one field. Each field in the family is countable. Thus none of the results below contradicts or purports to settle Glazer’s questions concerning uncountable topological arithmetic.

1.2 What was already known

Calderoni, Marker, Motto Ros, and Shani proved that embeddability of countable real closed fields is a complete analytic quasiorder, and that bi-embeddability is a complete analytic equivalence relation [3, Corollary 7.3]. Their route uses colored orders, ordered divisible abelian groups, and monomial fields. The isomorphism complexity of real closed fields also lies within the earlier o-minimal analysis of Rast and Sahota [5]. We use these as precedents, not as new discoveries.

The external descriptive completeness input for our strongest theorem is Louveau’s theorem that embeddability of countably colored countable linear orders is a complete analytic quasiorder, as recorded in [3, Theorem 7.1] and [4, Theorem 3.2]. Our proof reconstructs the algebraic coding explicitly and then localizes it inside one fixed countable surreal field and a closed coordinate family.

The manuscript answers the following *local refinement questions*. Can the complexity be confined to actual subfields of one explicitly given countable surreal field? Can this happen in a compact family with finite-coordinate membership tests? Can a single fixed source already give a non-Borel existence problem? How do transcendence degree and generic sampling affect that problem? These are the questions resolved here. We do not assert that they were previously published as open problems.

1.3 Main results at a glance

Let k be the real algebraic numbers. Enumerate the positive rational primes as $p_0, p_1, \dots$, and put

$$B = \{1\} \cup \{\sqrt{p_n} : n \in \mathbb{N}\}, \quad I = \mathbb{Q} \times B, \quad x_{q,b} = \omega^{b\omega^q}. \quad (1.1)$$

The powers of ω in this article are Conway’s omega-map. In particular, (1.1) makes no assumption about closure under Gonshor’s exponential.

For $A \subseteq I$, let

$$K_A = \text{rc}_{\mathbf{No}}(k(x_{q,b} : (q,b) \in A)), \quad K^\star = K_I. \quad (1.2)$$

Here $\text{rc}_{\mathbf{No}}$ means relative real closure. Its set-sized construction is explained in [section 2](#).

Theorem 1.1 (Fixed-ambient compact universality). *The field $K^\star$ is countable and real closed. The map*

$$\Phi : 2^I \longrightarrow 2^{K^\star}, \quad A \longmapsto K_A$$

is a homeomorphism onto a closed Cantor family $\mathcal{C}^\star$. Every member of $\mathcal{C}^\star$ is an elementary subfield of $K^\star$, and all have residue field k for their natural valuations. On $\mathcal{C}^\star$, unital field embeddability is a complete analytic quasiorder; bi-embeddability is a complete analytic equivalence relation. Isomorphism is Borel complete for countable structures.

The proof separates into the finite-support theorem ([theorems 4.1 and 4.3](#)), the uncolored classification ([theorem 5.1](#)), and the intrinsic quadratic-color coding ([theorems 7.3 and 7.4](#)).

For $S \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$, write

$$K_S^{(1)} = K_{S \times \{1\}}, \quad K^{(1)} = K_{\mathbb{Q}}, \quad \mathcal{C}^{(1)} = \{K_S^{(1)} : S \subseteq \mathbb{Q}\}.$$

Let $D = \{-n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ with its ordinary order, so that D has type $\omega^\star$. For a countable real closed field P , define

$$E_P^{(1)} = \{S \subseteq \mathbb{Q} : P \hookrightarrow K_S^{(1)}\}, \quad E_P^\star = \{A \subseteq I : P \hookrightarrow K_A\}.$$

Theorem 1.2 (Fixed sources and generic behavior). *The following hold.*

- (i) $E_{K_D^{(1)}}^{(1)}$ is analytic-complete; its complement is coanalytic-complete. The hardness persists when every target has countably infinite transcendence degree.
- (ii) In either coordinate family, a source of finite transcendence degree has an open embedding locus. A source of infinite transcendence degree has a locus with empty interior. Thus a nonempty locus is open exactly in the finite-transcendence-degree case.
- (iii) Every nonempty $E_P^{(1)}$ is dense, comeager, and of coin-flip measure one. In fact, a dense G_δ set of parameters gives fields isomorphic to $K^{(1)}$.
- (iv) Every nonempty $E_P^\star$ is dense. Each such locus is either meager or comeager and has measure zero or one. Both generic regimes occur: $E_{K_D^{(1)}}^\star$ is comeager and conull, whereas $E_{K^\star}^\star$ is meager and null. Both of these loci are analytic-complete.

All assertions are statements in ordinary ZFC. They concern actual unital field embeddings, not only embeddings that are required in advance to preserve chosen generators or monomials.

1.4 Provenance and place in ProveIt

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** This report is a single manuscript, printed in full: manuscript 04 of batch 90 of ProveIt's incoming-reports intake, delivered as the archive `Surreal_Subfield_Cantor_Research.zip` (544,930 bytes, nine members; inner directory `surreal_subfield_cantor/`, main file `article.tex`, 1843 lines, with a 27-page A4 PDF) in the arrival commit `a162e4386`, and placed in commit `12076b2e8` as `Algebra/SurrealNumbers/docs/foundations-and-computation/cantor-families-of-surreal-subfields`. Its subject is real closed subfields of $\mathbf{No}$, so the family `surreal/` would also have fitted; it was filed under `foundations-and-computation/` because its results are descriptive set theory about subfields of $\mathbf{No}$,

beside the complexity results of `polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic` and `omnific-notations`. No report of the collection asks its questions. The author lines read “Research article prepared for Vladimir Reshetnikov” and “AI-assisted mathematical draft”; the report is AI-assisted, unrefereed and not formalized, and its historical priority is not established. In the `[write]` notes, report paths are relative to `Algebra/SurrealNumbers/docs/` and Lean paths to `Algebra/SurrealNumbers/`, unless given in full.

Pin. The manuscript was written against ProveIt commit `7c0f2d9f92c3d51ec85703bed1022924a4b7359b` (3 October 2026, “New research reports”), an ancestor of the placement, quoted in [section 12](#) and in [\[12\]](#). Its statements about the repository are accurate at the pin and at the write: the three Lean files of the table in [section 12](#) are byte-identical at both (blobs `a0d30d424`, `632c027e9`, `e9b72519e`); `signSequenceIsRealClosed` is an instance (line 36 of `Surreal/Foundations/SignSequenceRealClosed.lean`); `Surreal/HahnSeries/RealClosed.lean` proves real closedness of set-sized Hahn fields over a real closed coefficient field with divisible exponent group; and the surreal README and the self-embedding report’s README separate formal declarations from unrefereed reports (the latter README has gained cross-references since the pin, without changing that). No repository statement is contradicted, and nothing needed retraction.

Formal status. No statement of this report is formalized. One finite algebraic input is available in Lean: [lemma 3.1](#) is the instance $M = \mathbb{Q}$, $a_i = p_i$, square roots taken in $\mathbb{R}$, of `tail:lem:signs` of `surreal/tail-spans-and-differential-transcendence`, which is proved as `Surreal.TailSigns.linearIndependent_mono` (in `Surreal/Algebra/MultiquadraticSigns.lean`, for any field with $2 \neq 0$ and roots in any extension field), with the hypothesis on the primes supplied by `Surreal.AlgebraicClosurePart.independentSquareClasses_prime` (in `Surreal/HahnSeries/AlgebraicCoefficientClosure.lean`); the specialization itself is not stated as a declaration. Nothing in the Lean tree states the double-monomial independence, the finite-support theorem, the value-group computation or any descriptive-set-theoretic result here. The formalization plan of [section 12](#) is a proposal.

Review in the Hilbert’s-tenth research tree. Another session inventoried the six batch-90 archives at their arrival commit (commit `bcc1a4438`, `Computability/HilbertTenthProblem/Papers/research-wip/native-stream-queue/review_polish_partx_c9bc70d8f.md`, with its JSON receipt). For this archive it read the delivered README in full (lines 1–86) and hashed the other eight members without reading them. Its routing result is that the report concerns “Analytic-complete embeddability inside a countable surreal field and finite-support topology; descriptive complexity is not finite arithmetic universality”. It executed no program, made no correctness finding and needed no scope correction; the Hilbert’s-tenth programme’s 84-operation universal polynomial is unaffected.

The cited prior work. The write checked [\[3\]](#) at arXiv (version 2 of 13 January 2023; the arXiv record notes acceptance in *Advances in Mathematics*). Its Section 7, “ODAG and other o-minimal theories”, states on PDF pages 33–34 Theorem 7.1 (embeddability of countably colored linear orders is a complete analytic quasiorder, “observed by Louveau”, citing Marcone–Rosendal, Theorem 3.2), Proposition 7.2 (a Borel reduction of colored-order embeddability to embeddability of ordered divisible abelian groups, through the finite-support reverse-lexicographic group with Archimedean component $H_{c(n)}$ at rank n , for pairwise non-embeddable divisible subgroups $H_n \subseteq \mathbb{R}$) and Corollary 7.3 (embeddability of countable real closed fields is a complete analytic quasiorder and bi-embeddability a complete analytic equivalence relation, proved on pages 34–35 through relative real closures of $k(t^g : g \in G)$ in Hahn fields); its Lemma 2.2 is Hion’s lemma. The citations of [sections 1](#) and [7](#) and of the bibliography match. [Theorems 7.3](#) and [7.4](#) thus compose the two steps of Proposition 7.2 and Corollary 7.3 inside one fixed field, with the explicit components $H_n = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[n]{p_n})$ of [lemma 7.2](#) in place of an abstract family, as the manuscript itself says ([section 1](#), and after [theorem 7.4](#)); the unrestricted theorem stays credited to [\[3\]](#). Rast–Sahota, Miller’s lecture notes, Marcone–Rosendal and Laver were not rechecked.

Neighbouring reports. Detailed notes follow the results concerned.

- `foundations-and-computation/definable-surreals-and-omnific-integers` and Part VII of `foundations-and-computation/birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets`: [lemma 3.2](#) is a case of the former’s Lemma 8.1 (`dsn:lem:cosets`), and an analogue of the latter’s `hset:kw:thm:double`; see the note after [lemma 3.2](#). Part VII otherwise proves different theorems (choiceless coding and universality of **No** over ZF), and shares no other result with this report.

- `surreal/surreal-self-embeddings`, cited as background [13]: `lemma 3.4` is the subfield form of its `sse:prop:valueaction` (note after the lemma). Its questions concern self-embeddings of **No**, not countable subfields; none is answered here.
- `surreal/independent-surreal-copies`: its `isc:thm:boolean` realizes a Boolean lattice of full Hahn fields, the analogue of `corollary 4.4` (note after the corollary).
- `foundations-and-computation/polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic`, Part II: its `pma:bor:lem:KB` contains `lemma 6.2` and the analytic-completeness assertion of `theorem 6.3` in complement form (note after `theorem 6.3`); its `pma:bor:thm:dichotomy` bears on `section 13`. Part XV (batch 92): its `pma:rk:thm:scaling` applies the integer comparisons of `lemma 3.4` to left-finite Levi-Civita fields (note after the lemma).
- `foundations-and-computation/surreal-fields-across-universes`, Part VIII: `univ:gs:thm:boolean` also indexes a family of real closed fields by subsets of a set, the class fields $\mathbf{No}^{M_A}$ of Cohen extensions, but there embeddability is exactly inclusion, $A \subseteq A'$; here it is embeddability of colored rank orders (`theorem 7.3`). Different objects, no shared proof.
- `foundations-and-computation/omnific-notations` (Part IV: $\mathbf{II}_1^1$ -complete support validity) uses the same ill-founded-tree toolkit on different objects; `foundations-and-computation/computable-surreals` constructs countable real closed subfields of **No** with effective presentations (its main theorem, label `thm:main` there), background for `Question 13.4` but no shared theorem.
- Batch-90 siblings, written concurrently: manuscript 06 (source 04 of `surreal/discrete-initial-subgroups-and-omnific-normalization`, labels `isg:ptg:`) also cites [1]; manuscripts 01 and 03 became Parts XI–XII of `polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic`, 05 Part VIII of `birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets`, and 02 Part II of the research-report collection’s `ordinals-and-order-types/measurable-box-games`. None shares a theorem with this report.

The write. Being a single source, the report needed no merge choices. The write prefixed all 56 delivered labels with `csf:` and updated every reference (63 `\cref` keys and 15 `\eqref`); added the labels `csf:sec:provenance`, `csf:sec:notation` and twelve question labels `csf:q:*` (the delivered questions had none); added these dated `[write]` notes, a title-page line and the `pageanchor` switch around the title page; and gave the labels of the 8 lemmas, 4 corollaries, 2 propositions and 12 questions `cleveref` type hints (such as `\label[lemma]`), because these environments share the theorem counter and the delivered text’s references named every one of them “theorem”. No statement, proof, number or non-claim of the manuscript was changed, and no section, theorem, equation or question number moved.

1.5 Notation

[write] Added 4 October 2026, batch 90. The manuscript’s symbols, each with its meaning here and the reading to avoid. No symbol was renamed.

Symbol	Meaning here	Not to be read as
ω^x, ω^x	Conway’s omega-map (monomials)	Gonshor’s exp
k	the field of real algebraic numbers, fixed	a variable field
p_n, B, I	the n th prime; $\{1\} \cup \{\sqrt{p_n}\}; \mathbb{Q} \times B$	
b	an element of B (a real coefficient)	the birthday $b(a)$ of <code>section 2</code>
$x_{q,b}, t_q$	$\omega^{b\omega^q}; t_q = x_{q,1}$	
$K_A, K^*, K_S^{(1)}, K^{(1)}$	relative real closures (<code>equation (1.2)</code>); $K_S^{(1)} = K_{S \times \{1\}}$	K_A is not a Hahn field
$\mathcal{C}^*, \mathcal{C}^{(1)}$	the families $\{K_A\}, \{K_S^{(1)}\}$, subsets of 2^{K^*}	
rcNo	relative real closure inside No (a set)	a class construction
$D(a)$	finite generator support (<code>theorem 4.1</code>)	normal-form support supp
D, P_-	the order $\{-n\}$ of type ω^* ; $P_- = K_D^{(1)}$	$D(a), D_A$

Symbol	Meaning here	Not to be read as
D_A, A_q	complete-column ranks $\{q : A_q = B\}$; the column $\{b : (q, b) \in A\}$	
J_A	$\{q : H_A(q) \neq 0\}$ (theorem 3.3) = $\{q : A_q \neq \emptyset\}$ (section 10); the two definitions agree	
$H_A(q), \Gamma_A$	component $\text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}}\{b : (q, b) \in A\}$; value group (equation (3.2))	
H_n, H	$\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{p_n})$ as an ordered group; $\text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} B$	ordered additive groups; H_n is also a field (used in lemma 7.2), H is not
v	natural valuation, $v(x) = -(\text{leading exponent})$	a Conway exponent
$E_P^*, E_P^{(1)}$	fixed-source embedding loci, sets of parameters	a predicate or relation
Σ_1^1, Π_1^1 analytic-complete	boldface analytic, coanalytic a set to which every analytic set reduces continuously	a σ -algebra complete analytic <i>quasiorder</i> (section 6)
KB, IF, WF, Tr	Kleene–Brouwer order; ill-founded and well-founded trees; trees	
S_L, e_L S_T, W, h	rational placement of an order L on $\mathbb{N}$ tree code (equation (6.1)) and its prefix; h also names other order embeddings	S_T (tree code)
$Z(L), G, \psi, R_T, \mathcal{N}$	integer-sum transform; $G = Z(\text{KB})$; $\mathcal{N}$ non-scattered suborders of $\mathbb{Q}$	
M_L, A_L	colored-order code (equation (7.1))	
$\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{W}_P, \tau_r, \mu$	sets S dense in $\mathbb{Q}$; witness relation; translation; coin-flip measure	a measure on No
$\beta, b(a)$	a birthday cutoff and the birthday of a	an optimal bound

Across the collection: K_A is not **independent-surreal-copies'** E_J (full Hahn fields), Part VII's T_X or U_κ of **birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets**, or **surreal-fields-across-universes'** $\mathbf{No}^{MA}$; the tree-coding embedding h plays the role of μ_{KB} in **polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic**; and E_P^* is unrelated to the enumeration predicate E of Parts VI and VIII of **birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets**.

2 Foundations, conventions, and the proof boundary

2.1 Set-sized relative real closures

We use the standard surreal ordered field and its normal-form theorem [9, 10]. For a set-sized ordered subfield $F \subset \mathbf{No}$, define

$$\text{rc}_{\mathbf{No}}(F) = \{a \in \mathbf{No} : a \text{ is algebraic over } F\}.$$

Although the notation quantifies over **No**, its output is a set. Indeed, $F[X]$ is a set, and a nonzero polynomial has at most its degree many roots in any field. For each polynomial and each possible root index, its ordered list of roots, when present in **No**, is uniquely determined. Replacement collects these roots into a set. Their union is exactly the displayed class.

This set is an algebraic extension field of F . It is real closed: positive square roots and roots of odd-degree polynomials exist in **No**, and any such root of a polynomial with coefficients algebraic over F is again algebraic over F . When F is countable, there are only countably many polynomials and finitely many roots per nonzero polynomial, so the relative real closure is countable.

Equivalently, one can first construct the abstract real closure of F and use its unique order-preserving embedding into $\mathbf{No}$ over F . Once $K^\star$ has been constructed, every subsequent definition can be written entirely inside the set $K^\star$:

$$K_A = \{a \in K^\star : a \text{ is algebraic over } k(x_i : i \in A)\}. \quad (2.1)$$

The two definitions agree. In particular, $\mathcal{C}^\star$ is a set of subsets of a countable set, not a collection requiring quantification over arbitrary proper classes.

2.2 One ordinal cutoff suffices

Let $b(a)$ denote the birthday of a surreal a . Since $K^\star$ is a set,

$$\beta = \sup\{b(a) + 1 : a \in K^\star\}$$

is an ordinal, and $K^\star \subseteq \mathbf{No}_{<\beta}$. Therefore the same birthday cutoff contains every field in both families. No numerical bound for β is needed or asserted. The cutoff itself is not being asserted to be a field, and its full structure is not used.

This is also a useful type-theoretic separation. A formalization can work with a set-sized ambient real closed field, its countable independent family, and relative algebraic closures. The embedding into a suitable universe of surreals is a separate interface. One need not form a type of all classes of surreal numbers.

2.3 Embeddings and elementarity

By an embedding we mean a unital field homomorphism. Such a map between real closed fields is injective and order preserving: positive elements are exactly the nonzero squares. It reflects the order as well. It fixes k pointwise, because a real algebraic number is specified uniquely by its minimal polynomial over $\mathbb{Q}$ and an isolating interval with rational endpoints.

We use two standard consequences of real-closed-field theory. An ordered field has a real closure unique up to a unique ordered isomorphism over that field; and every embedding between real closed fields is elementary in the language of ordered rings, by quantifier elimination for RCF [11]. Thus “elementary” in [theorem 1.1](#) introduces no additional coding predicate or saturation assumption.

2.4 External inputs versus new proofs

The external inputs are surreal real closedness and normal forms, elementary field-theoretic algebraic dependence, real-closure uniqueness, quantifier elimination for RCF, completeness of ill-founded trees, Borel completeness of countable-order isomorphism, and completeness of colored-order embeddability. All other steps needed for the stated package are proved below. In particular, neither an unproved universality assertion about $\mathbf{No}$ nor a global extension of our embeddings to $\mathbf{No}$ is needed.

3 Monomial coordinates and their exact valuation invariants

3.1 Independent algebraic real coefficients

For a finite set of distinct primes $p_1, \dots, p_m$, the real multiquadratic field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{p_1}, \dots, \sqrt{p_m})$ has basis

$$\left\{ \sqrt{\prod_{j \in J} p_j} : J \subseteq \{1, \dots, m\} \right\}.$$

Here is an elementary induction justifying the basis and all independent sign changes. Assume the statement for the first m primes, and suppose $\alpha = \sqrt{p_{m+1}}$ belonged to the field they generate. Each of its sign-changing automorphisms sends α to α or $-\alpha$, since these are the roots of $X^2 - p_{m+1}$. In the asserted basis for the first m primes, simultaneous eigenvectors of all sign changes are rational multiples of individual basis monomials: distinct monomials have distinct sign characters. Thus $\alpha = c\sqrt{\prod_{j \in J} p_j}$ for some $c \in \mathbb{Q}$. Squaring contradicts the odd valuation at the new prime p_{m+1} . The next adjunction therefore has degree two. Old sign changes extend while fixing the new square root, and the new square root has its own sign change. This proves the induction, beginning with $\mathbb{Q}$.

Lemma 3.1. *The set B in (1.1) is linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$. More generally, distinct squarefree radical monomials in finitely many primes are $\mathbb{Q}$ -linearly independent.*

Proof. Each alleged dependence lies in one finite multiquadratic field. Apply its independent sign-changing automorphisms, multiply by the corresponding characters, and average. Each coefficient is isolated and hence zero. $\square$

For a reader wishing to avoid the degree formulation, the same elementary multiquadratic lemma is a standard finite algebraic input; the verification script includes an exact character-orthogonality check, but that finite check is not the proof for arbitrary m .

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** For arbitrary m , and indeed for arbitrarily many primes, this lemma is formally proved in ProveIt's Lean development: it is the instance $M = \mathbb{Q}$, $a_i = p_i$, with square roots in $\mathbb{R}$, of `Surreal.TailSigns.linearIndependent_mono` (`tail:lem:signs` of `surreal/tail-spans-and-differential-transcendence`, proved by the same sign-change induction), whose square-class hypothesis for distinct primes is `Surreal.AlgebraicClosurePart.independentSquareClasses_prime`. The specialization is not itself a declaration; see [section 1.4](#).

3.2 The transcendence basis

A finite surreal normal form

$$g = \sum_{q \in F} r_q \omega^q, \quad r_q \in \mathbb{R},$$

is positive exactly when the coefficient at the largest q with $r_q \neq 0$ is positive. For distinct exponents $g < h$, the ratio $\omega^h/\omega^g = \omega^{h-g}$ exceeds every positive real number. Also $\omega^{g+h} = \omega^g \omega^h$.

Lemma 3.2 (Independent double monomials). *The family $(x_{q,b})_{(q,b) \in I}$ is algebraically independent over k .*

Proof. An ordinary monomial with finite nonnegative integer exponent vector $\nu = (\nu_{q,b})$ has value

$$\prod_{q,b} x_{q,b}^{\nu_{q,b}} = \omega^{g_\nu}, \quad g_\nu = \sum_q \left(\sum_b \nu_{q,b} b \right) \omega^q.$$

If $\nu \neq \mu$, then $g_\nu \neq g_\mu$ by [lemma 3.1](#) and uniqueness of the finite normal form. A nonzero polynomial in finitely many $x_{q,b}$ therefore becomes a finite sum of distinct surreal monomials with nonzero coefficients in k . Its largest-exponent summand dominates all other summands, so the sum is nonzero. $\square$

Consequently

$$\text{trdeg}_k K_A = |A|, \quad (3.1)$$

where the right side is a finite cardinal or $\aleph_0$. The use of real algebraic b does not make $x_{q,b}$ algebraic over $x_{q,1}$: an irrational multiple of the exponent is precisely what prevents an integral polynomial relation.

[write] Added 4 October 2026, batch 90. [Lemma 3.2](#) is a case of Lemma 8.1 (dsn:lem:cosets, “Disjoint support cosets”, that report’s source 04) of foundations-and-computation/definable-surreals-and-omnific-integers: take the subfield k , whose nonzero elements have normal-form support $\{0\}$, the subgroup $G = \{0\}$, and $g_{q,b} = b\omega^q$; a nonzero finitely supported integer combination of the $g_{q,b}$ is nonzero by [lemma 3.1](#) and uniqueness of the finite normal form, so the monomials $\omega^{g_{q,b}} = x_{q,b}$ are algebraically independent over k . Part VII of foundations-and-computation/birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets proves the coefficient-one analogue over $\mathbb{R}$, the double monomials $\omega^{\omega^{j(x)}}$ (Theorem 43.1, hset:kw:thm:double), by the same leading-term argument, and its Remark hset:kw:rem:other records that it too is a case of dsn:lem:cosets. Both are credited; the proof above is printed as the manuscript’s own and claims no novelty beyond the radical coefficients $b \in B$, which make several independent generators share one rank.

3.3 Natural valuation

For an ordered field F , its natural valuation ring and maximal ideal are

$$\mathcal{O}_F = \{a : |a| \leq n \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}\}, \quad \mathfrak{m}_F = \{a : |a| < 1/n \text{ for every } n \in \mathbb{N}_{>0}\}.$$

The value group is the multiplicative group modulo bounded positive units, written additively with the usual valuation orientation. For a nonzero surreal with leading normal-form exponent g , we identify its value with $-g$. Thus $v(x_{q,b}) = -b\omega^q$.

For $A \subseteq I$, set

$$H_A(q) = \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}}\{b : (q, b) \in A\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}, \quad \Gamma_A = \bigoplus_{q \in \mathbb{Q}} H_A(q) \omega^q. \quad (3.2)$$

The direct sum consists of finite-support vectors. It is ordered by the largest nonzero coordinate and its real coefficient. Empty components are omitted from its rank chain.

Theorem 3.3 (Exact value group and residue field). *For every $A \subseteq I$, the natural value group of K_A is Γ_A , and its residue field is exactly k . If $J_A = \{q : H_A(q) \neq 0\}$, then the Archimedean rank chain of Γ_A is $(J_A, <)$, with component $H_A(q)$ at rank q .*

Proof. Write $F_A = k(x_i : i \in A)$. The leading-exponent computation shows that $v(F_A^\times)$ is the integral span of the $b\omega^q$ for $(q, b) \in A$. Every rational multiple of such a value occurs in K_A , by taking positive integer roots of monomials. Hence $\Gamma_A \subseteq v(K_A^\times)$.

Conversely, let $a \in K_A^\times$ satisfy a nonzero polynomial relation $\sum_{i=0}^d c_i a^i = 0$ over F_A . Among its nonzero summands, the minimum of $v(c_i) + iv(a)$ is attained at least twice: a unique least-value term cannot cancel with terms of greater value. For two distinct such indices,

$$(i - j)v(a) = v(c_j) - v(c_i).$$

The right side lies in the integral span just computed. The ordered value group is torsion free, so $v(a)$ lies in its rational span Γ_A . This proves the value-group assertion.

The residue of a unit in F_A is the ratio of two leading coefficients, and therefore lies in k . For a unit $a \in K_A$, choose a polynomial relation over F_A and divide all coefficients by a coefficient of least value. All normalized coefficients belong to the valuation ring of F_A , and at least one has nonzero residue. Reduction yields a nonzero polynomial over k satisfied by the residue of a . The residue field is ordered and k is real closed, so this algebraic residue belongs to k . Elements of positive value have residue zero, and all constants in k occur. Thus the residue field is k .

For the rank assertion, two positive elements of Γ_A are Archimedean equivalent exactly when their largest nonzero coordinates coincide. If the largest coordinates differ, no integer multiple of the smaller-rank element reaches the larger-rank one. At a fixed coordinate, the leading coefficients are positive real numbers, so sufficiently large integer multiples compare them in both directions. Finally, quotienting vectors supported at coordinates $\leq q$ by those supported at coordinates $< q$ gives exactly $H_A(q)$. $\square$

3.4 Why arbitrary field embeddings preserve these invariants

Lemma 3.4 (Intrinsic value-group functor). *An embedding $f : F \hookrightarrow G$ of ordered fields induces an ordered-group embedding $\bar{f} : v(F^\times) \hookrightarrow v(G^\times)$. It also induces an order embedding of Archimedean rank chains and, at each source rank, an ordered embedding of the corresponding Archimedean components.*

Proof. All comparisons $|a| \leq n|b|$ are preserved and reflected by f . Hence bounded-ratio equivalence and the comparison of natural values are preserved and reflected. The resulting map on values is well defined, injective, and additive because f respects multiplication.

For positive value-group elements, Archimedean equivalence is expressed by two inequalities of the form $g \leq nh$. These too are preserved and reflected. At the rank of a positive g , form the convex subgroups

$$C_g = \{h : |h| \leq ng \text{ for some } n \geq 1\}, \quad D_g = \{h : n|h| < g \text{ for every } n \geq 1\}.$$

The map sends C_g into $C_{\bar{f}(g)}$ and sends D_g into $D_{\bar{f}(g)}$, with the latter membership reflected. It therefore induces an injective ordered homomorphism between the quotients. $\square$

This lemma is essential. Restricting attention to generator-preserving embeddings would prove only a sufficient condition. The intrinsic valuation recovers a necessary condition for *every* field embedding.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** The first assertion is the subfield form of `sse:prop:valueaction` of `surreal/surreal-self-embeddings`, which proves by the same integer-comparison argument that every field self-embedding j of **No** induces an ordered value-group embedding τ_j ; the component maps on convex quotients are the step used in the proof of Proposition 7.2 of [3] (see [section 1.4](#)).

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 92.** Part XV of `foundations-and-computation/polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic` (batch-92 manuscript 05;

AI-assisted, unrefereed, not formalized) uses the same integer comparisons for field embeddings $\mathcal{L}^\Gamma \rightarrow \mathcal{L}^\Delta$ between left-finite Levi-Civita fields with real algebraic coefficients and exponent groups $0 \neq \Gamma, \Delta \leq_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{R}$ (nonzero rational vector subspaces), where the induced value-group map is multiplication by one real $\lambda > 0$ (`pma:rk:thm:scaling`), and it classifies these embeddings by triples (λ, c, u) (`pma:rk:thm:parameters`). Those fields are complete and uncountable, not countable subfields of $\mathbf{No}$, so [question 13.8](#) is not answered. Its Cantor family of closed immediate self-copies of one Polish field (`pma:rk:thm:family`) is a different object from the Cantor families of countable subfields here.

Remark 3.5 (The rational-vector-space hypothesis in the reciprocal note). The batch-92 note originally wrote only $0 \neq \Gamma, \Delta \leq \mathbb{R}$ while citing the complete positive-character parametrization of `pma:rk:thm:parameters`. Read as allowing arbitrary additive subgroups, that formulation is false. Take $\Gamma = \Delta = \mathbb{Z}$ and let k be the real algebraic numbers. The left-finite field is then the Laurent-series field $k((t))$, and

$$\sum_n a_n t^n \mapsto \sum_n (-1)^n a_n t^n$$

is a field automorphism with inverse itself. It sends t to $-t$, so its leading character has $c(1) = -1$, excluded by the cited parametrization's condition $c(\gamma) > 0$. The cited theorem assumes nonzero $\mathbb{Q}$ -subspaces, under which its real-closedness and order argument applies. The corrected note retains that hypothesis; this counterexample concerns the unrestricted positive-character classification, not every possible valuation-scaling assertion for other exponent groups.

4 Finite supports and a compact Boolean family

4.1 A general algebraic lemma

The next theorem is not specific to surreal numbers. Let F be a field, let $(t_i)_{i \in I}$ be algebraically independent over F , and suppose M is algebraic over $F(t_i : i \in I)$. For $A \subseteq I$, define

$$M_A = \{a \in M : a \text{ is algebraic over } F(t_i : i \in A)\}.$$

Theorem 4.1 (Unique finite support). *For every $a \in M$ there exists a unique finite $D(a) \subseteq I$ such that*

$$a \in M_A \iff D(a) \subseteq A \quad (A \subseteq I). \quad (4.1)$$

Moreover $D(t_i) = \{i\}$, and $D(a) = \emptyset$ exactly when a is algebraic over F .

Proof. A polynomial witnessing that a is algebraic over $F(t_i : i \in I)$ uses only finitely many generators. Choose a finite set D minimal under inclusion such that a is algebraic over $F(t_i : i \in D)$.

We first recall the elementary exchange step. If a is algebraic over $L(t)$ but transcendental over L , clearing denominators gives a nonzero $P(X, Y) \in L[X, Y]$ with $P(a, t) = 0$. Viewed as a polynomial in Y , it remains nonzero after $X = a$, because a is transcendental over L . Thus t is algebraic over $L(a)$.

Now suppose $a \in M_A$. Some finite $C \subseteq A$ already suffices for this algebraicity. If $i \in D \setminus C$, minimality of D and exchange show that t_i is algebraic over $F(a, t_j : j \in D \setminus \{i\})$. Since a is algebraic over $F(t_j : j \in C)$, transitivity of algebraicity makes t_i algebraic over

$$F(t_j : j \in C \cup (D \setminus \{i\})).$$

This contradicts algebraic independence, because i is absent from the index set. Consequently $D \subseteq C \subseteq A$.

The converse follows by monotonicity of algebraicity. This proves (4.1); it also proves uniqueness. The final two assertions follow immediately from independence and the definition. $\square$

Remark 4.2 (Generator support is not normal-form support). An algebraic element can have infinitely many terms in its surreal normal form and still have a one-element generator support. For example, $\sqrt{1 + x_i^{-1}}$ is algebraic over $k(x_i)$ and its support in the present sense is $\{i\}$, even though its usual infinitesimal expansion has infinitely many terms. No claim that algebraic normal forms are finite is being made.

4.2 Topological consequences

Apply [theorem 4.1](#) to $F = k$, $t_i = x_i$, and $M = K^*$. Fix an enumeration of the countably infinite set I and an enumeration of K^* . The power sets 2^I and 2^{K^*} carry their ordinary product Cantor topologies.

Theorem 4.3 (Closed coordinate family). *The map $\Phi(A) = K_A$ is continuous and injective, hence a homeomorphism onto a closed subspace $\mathcal{C}^* \subseteq 2^{K^*}$ homeomorphic to Cantor space. Every coordinate test $a \in K_A$ is clopen as a condition on A . Every K_A is an elementary real closed subfield of K^* .*

Proof. For a fixed $a \in K^*$, [theorem 4.1](#) gives

$$\{A : a \in K_A\} = \bigcap_{i \in D(a)} \{A : i \in A\},$$

a finite intersection of clopen sets. Thus every membership coordinate of Φ is continuous. Since $x_i \in K_A$ exactly when $i \in A$, the map is injective. A continuous injection from compact 2^I into Hausdorff 2^{K^*} is a homeomorphism onto its compact, and hence closed, image. Real closedness was established in [section 2](#); elementarity follows from quantifier elimination. $\square$

Corollary 4.4 (Coordinate lattice). *For arbitrary families $(A_j)_{j \in J}$,*

$$\bigcap_{j \in J} K_{A_j} = K_{\bigcap_j A_j}, \quad \text{rc}_{K^*} \left(\text{field generated by } \bigcup_j K_{A_j} \right) = K_{\bigcup_j A_j}.$$

For a nonempty directed family under inclusion,

$$\bigcup_j K_{A_j} = K_{\bigcup_j A_j}.$$

Consequently $\mathcal{C}^$, with these relative meet and join operations, is a complete Boolean lattice isomorphic to $\mathcal{P}(I)$.*

Proof. The intersection assertion is (4.1). For the join, every member on the left is algebraic over the field generated by coordinates in the union, while that field contains every required generator. Relative real closure gives equality. In the directed case, the finite support of an element in the right-hand side is already contained in one member of the family. The Boolean complement of K_A within this coordinate lattice is $K_{I \setminus A}$; the lattice bottom is k . $\square$

These joins are not literal unions of two fields. For instance, $x_i + x_j$ can lie in $K_{\{i,j\}}$ without belonging to either $K_{\{i\}}$ or $K_{\{j\}}$.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** `surreal/independent-surreal-copies` proves a Boolean lattice of the same shape for *full Hahn fields*: for an independent family of exponent groups G_i over a core H , the fields E_J on G_J satisfy $E_J \cap E_T = E_{J \cap T}$, with full Hahn join $E_{J \cup T}$ (`isc:thm:boolean`). There the fields are set-sized or class-sized Hahn fields and the proof uses normal-form supports; here they are countable relative real closures and the proof uses algebraic exchange ([theorem 4.1](#)). No result is shared.

4.3 Uniform codes on the domain $\mathbb{N}$

The family can be transferred to the usual space of countable structures without adding complexity. Fix an enumeration (z_n) of K^* without repetitions, and enumerate each K_A by the increasing indices of its members in this list. The m th enumerated element depends on only finitely many tests $z_n \in K_A$, and hence continuously on A . The inherited addition, multiplication, order, and constants can then be coded on $\mathbb{N}$. Every individual operation-table entry depends locally on finitely many membership tests. This yields a continuous presentation map into the space of structures in the countable ordered-field language.

Continuity here is relative to a fixed enumeration and the product structure space. It does not assert an effective algorithm for computing all surreal algebraic numbers or their supports from an arbitrary external notation.

5 The rank-one family remembers exactly a countable order

The rank-one field $K_S^{(1)}$ is generated, up to real closure, by $t_q = x_{q,1} = \omega^{\omega^q}$ for $q \in S$. Its natural value group is

$$\Gamma_S^{(1)} = \bigoplus_{q \in S} \mathbb{Q}\omega^q. \quad (5.1)$$

Theorem 5.1 (Exact embedding and isomorphism classification). *For arbitrary $S, T \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$,*

$$K_S^{(1)} \hookrightarrow K_T^{(1)} \iff (S, <) \hookrightarrow (T, <), \quad (5.2)$$

$$K_S^{(1)} \cong K_T^{(1)} \iff (S, <) \cong (T, <). \quad (5.3)$$

The assertions include finite and empty index sets.

Proof. An embedding of fields induces an embedding of natural value groups by [lemma 3.4](#). The Archimedean rank chains of (5.1) are S and T , respectively, so this induces an order embedding $S \hookrightarrow T$. An isomorphism induces an order isomorphism of ranks.

Conversely, given an order embedding $h : S \hookrightarrow T$, send t_q to $t_{h(q)}$. Algebraic independence makes this a field embedding on the rational-function fields. It preserves order: for any finite polynomial, the comparison of two monomial exponents is determined by the largest coordinate at which their integer exponent vectors differ. That coordinate and its coefficient are preserved by h . The sign of the leading coefficient is unchanged. The same follows for quotients.

The ordered embedding extends uniquely to real closures. Its image is $K_{h(S)}^{(1)} \subseteq K_T^{(1)}$. If h is onto, the extension is onto. For $S = \emptyset$, the source is k and its value rank is empty, as required. $\square$

Example 5.2 (Equal coarse invariants, different fields). Let S have order type ω and T order type ω^* . Both fields have residue field k , countably infinite transcendence degree, and value groups abstractly isomorphic to the $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space $\mathbb{Q}^{(\mathbb{N})}$. As bare ordered sets, both fields have order type $\mathbb{Q}$. Nevertheless they are not isomorphic, and neither embeds into the other, because neither of these two rank orders embeds into the other.

Remark 5.3 (No classification of all individual maps). [theorem 5.1](#) classifies the *existence* of an embedding and the resulting isomorphism types. It does not say that every embedding sends each displayed monomial to a displayed monomial. An embedding can contain additional unit factors or other algebraic choices. Only its induced rank map is used in the necessary direction.

6 Descriptive complexity in the rank-one family

6.1 Three different completeness notions

An analytic set is a projection of a Borel set in a product of standard Borel spaces. An analytic subset of a Polish space is *analytic-complete* if every analytic subset of Baire space continuously reduces to it. The completeness statements for individual sets below use this convention. We exhibit explicit continuous reductions from the space of ill-founded trees.

For quasiorders, the stronger phrase *complete analytic quasiorder* means that for every analytic quasiorder R on a standard Borel space X there is a Borel map f with

$$x R y \iff f(x) Q f(y).$$

Both coordinates use the same map. Analytic-completeness of a relation viewed merely as a set of pairs does not imply this universal property. Finally, *Borel complete for countable structures*, or S_∞ -complete, refers to reducing arbitrary isomorphism relations on countable structures to the target isomorphism relation.

6.2 A Borel rational placement of countable orders

Let L be a strict linear order on $\mathbb{N}$. Choose once and for all an enumeration of $\mathbb{Q}$. Recursively select $e_L(n)$ to be the first unused rational satisfying

$$e_L(i) < e_L(n) \iff i <_L n \quad (i < n).$$

At each stage, only finitely many inequalities are imposed. Density and lack of endpoints of $\mathbb{Q}$ ensure a solution. The first $n + 1$ choices depend only on the restriction of L to $\{0, \dots, n\}$, so each coordinate $e_L(n)$ is Borel, indeed locally constant. Therefore

$$S_L = \{e_L(n) : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

is a Borel function of L , because $q \in S_L$ is a countable union of the Borel conditions $e_L(n) = q$.

Corollary 6.1 (Borel-complete isomorphism). *Isomorphism on $\mathcal{C}^{(1)}$, and hence on $\mathcal{C}^*$, is Borel complete for countable structures.*

Proof. The map $L \mapsto K_{S_L}^{(1)}$ is a Borel reduction of countable-linear-order isomorphism by [theorem 5.1](#). The latter isomorphism relation is Borel complete [6, 5]. The upper classification bound follows because our fields are countable structures in a countable language, with the uniform codes described above. $\square$

6.3 A fixed source with an analytic-complete locus

Let Tr be the closed subspace of $2^{\mathbb{N}^{<\mathbb{N}}}$ consisting of prefix-closed trees. Its members may be empty. A branch is a function $f \in \mathbb{N}^{\mathbb{N}}$ whose finite initial segments all belong to the tree. The

set IF of trees with a branch is analytic-complete [8, Proposition 1.4.28]. Its complement WF is coanalytic-complete.

Fix the Kleene–Brouwer order on $\mathbb{N}^{<\mathbb{N}}$: a proper extension precedes its initial segment, and otherwise the first unequal entries are compared in their usual order. Write it as $<_{\text{KB}}$.

Lemma 6.2. *A tree T has a branch exactly when its Kleene–Brouwer order is not a well-order.*

Proof. The successive initial segments of a branch form a strictly decreasing Kleene–Brouwer sequence. Conversely, if T has no branch, the relation of proper extension on its nodes is well founded. By well-founded induction, the Kleene–Brouwer order on the subtree above a node s is a well-order: it is the ordinal sum, in increasing order of n , of the orders on the subtrees above $s \frown n$, followed by the node s itself. Every summand is a well-order by the induction hypothesis, and a sum of well-orders over a subset of $\mathbb{N}$ is a well-order. Apply this at the root; the empty-tree case is immediate. $\square$

Choose one order embedding

$$h : \omega + (\mathbb{N}^{<\mathbb{N}}, <_{\text{KB}}) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{Q}.$$

It exists because this is a countable linear order. Denote the image of the first summand by W , and for $T \in \text{Tr}$ put

$$S_T = W \cup \{h(s) : s \in T\}. \quad (6.1)$$

This map is continuous: membership at a fixed rational coordinate is constant, or is one membership bit of T .

Theorem 6.3 (One fixed field already has complete analytic existence). *Let $P_- = K_D^{(1)}$, where D has order type ω^* . Then*

$$E_{P_-}^{(1)} = \{S : (S, <) \text{ is not a well-order}\}$$

is analytic-complete. Its complement is coanalytic-complete. Moreover,

$$T \in \text{IF} \iff P_- \hookrightarrow K_{S_T}^{(1)},$$

where every field $K_{S_T}^{(1)}$ has transcendence degree $\aleph_0$ over k , residue field k , and abstract value group $\mathbb{Q}^{(\mathbb{N})}$.

Proof. By theorem 5.1, $P_- \hookrightarrow K_S^{(1)}$ exactly when ω^* embeds into S , that is, exactly when S admits an infinite strictly decreasing sequence. For countable linear orders in ZFC, this is precisely failure of well-foundedness. The existence of such a sequence is analytic.

In (6.1), the added ω summand is a well-order and cannot create an infinite decreasing sequence. Therefore the target order is ill founded exactly when the Kleene–Brouwer order on T is ill founded, which is equivalent to $T \in \text{IF}$ by lemma 6.2. The reduction is continuous. The fixed infinite prefix W ensures $|S_T| = \aleph_0$, even for empty or finite T . The algebraic invariants follow from theorem 3.3 and (3.1). $\square$

[write] Added 4 October 2026, batch 90. Part II of

foundations-and-computation/polish-models-of-omnific-arithmetic proves the same Kleene–Brouwer lemma inside its Lemma pma:bor:lem:KB, with a fixed order embedding

$\mu_{\text{KB}} : \mathbb{N}^{<\mathbb{N}} \rightarrow \mathbb{Q} \cap (0, 1)$ in the role of h , and concludes that

$\text{WO}(\mathbb{Q}) = \{S \in 2^{\mathbb{Q}} : (S, <) \text{ is well-ordered}\}$ is Π_1^1 -complete. By the first display of theorem 6.3,

$E_{P_-}^{(1)} = 2^{\mathbb{Q}} \setminus \text{WO}(\mathbb{Q})$, so the analytic-completeness of $E_{P_-}^{(1)}$ is the complement form of that lemma,

transported by [theorem 5.1](#). Both arguments are the standard one and both are credited; the manuscript's reduction adds the fixed well-ordered prefix W , so that every target field has transcendence degree $\aleph_0$. That report's Theorem 18.4 (`pma:bor:thm:dichotomy`) also shows that $\text{WO}(L)$ is Borel for scattered countable L and Π_1^1 -complete otherwise. Hence, as an observation of the write, if the rank-one parameters are restricted to subsets of a fixed countable $L \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$, the locus of P_- is Borel exactly when L is scattered; this bears on, but does not answer, Question [13.1](#).

6.4 A second tree transform: copies of the rational order

A related construction gives a self-contained hardness proof for the predicate that a suborder of $\mathbb{Q}$ contains a copy of $\mathbb{Q}$. It will sharpen the rare-ambient theorem in the larger family.

For a countable linear order L , let

$$Z(L) = \bigoplus_{l \in L} \mathbb{Z}$$

with the reverse-lexicographic order: a nonzero vector is positive when its coefficient at the largest nonzero rank is positive.

Lemma 6.4 (An integer-sum transform). *The order $Z(L)$ contains a copy of $\mathbb{Q}$ if and only if L is not a well-order.*

Proof. If L contains a decreasing sequence with range D of type ω^* , consider the subgroup $Z(D)$. For $f < g$ in it, choose a rank $d \in D$ strictly below the largest nonzero rank of $g - f$. The unit vector e_d then satisfies $0 < e_d < g - f$, so $f < f + e_d < g$. This subgroup is a countable dense linear order without endpoints, and hence isomorphic to $\mathbb{Q}$.

Conversely, suppose $u : \mathbb{Q} \hookrightarrow Z(L)$. Choose rational endpoints $a < b$ and let l be the largest rank of $u(b) - u(a)$. Throughout the interval $u(a) < u(r) < u(b)$, all coordinates above l equal the corresponding endpoint coordinates. The coordinate at l can take only finitely many integer values between its two endpoint values. Among the infinitely many rational $r \in (a, b)$, choose two $a' < b'$ with the same coefficient at l . Their nonzero difference has largest rank $l' < l$. Repeating this argument inside (a', b') produces an infinite strictly decreasing sequence of ranks in L . Thus L is not well ordered. $\square$

Fix the countable ordered group $G = Z((\mathbb{N}^{<\mathbb{N}}, <_{\text{KB}}))$, and choose once and for all an order embedding $\psi : G \hookrightarrow \mathbb{Q}$. For a tree T , define

$$R_T = \{\psi(g) : g \in G, \text{supp}(g) \subseteq T\}.$$

Each membership coordinate of R_T is either constantly false or a finite conjunction of membership bits of T . Therefore $T \mapsto R_T$ is continuous. The induced order on R_T is exactly $Z((T, <_{\text{KB}}))$.

Theorem 6.5 (A second analytic-complete fixed source). *The set*

$$\mathcal{N} = \{S \subseteq \mathbb{Q} : (\mathbb{Q}, <) \hookrightarrow (S, <)\} = E_{K^{(1)}}^{(1)}$$

is analytic-complete. Indeed,

$$T \in \text{IF} \iff R_T \in \mathcal{N}.$$

Proof. The equivalence follows from [lemmas 6.2](#) and [6.4](#). The reduction is continuous, and the target condition is analytic because an order embedding is a countable function satisfying countably many tests. The field equality follows from [theorem 5.1](#). $\square$

In standard terminology, $\mathcal{N}$ consists of the non-scattered suborders of $\mathbb{Q}$. The proof above establishes the required completeness directly, rather than assuming an additional classification theorem about scattered orders.

6.5 Witness selection and its exact limitation

Fix an enumeration (a_n) of a source P . A function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow K^\star$ codes an embedding $P \hookrightarrow K_A$ if it is injective, respects the field tables and constants of P , and all its values belong to K_A . Each finite field-table test is clopen in the function space. By finite supports, each test $f(n) \in K_A$ is also clopen. Their countable intersection is a closed witness relation

$$\mathcal{W}_P \subseteq 2^I \times (K^\star)^\mathbb{N}.$$

Projection proves that every fixed-source locus is analytic. The analogous relation for two varying fields is at least Borel, which suffices for the analytic upper bound on embeddability.

Corollary 6.6 (No total Borel solver). *There is no total Borel function on $2^\mathbb{Q}$ that outputs a valid embedding $P_- \hookrightarrow K_S^{(1)}$ whenever one exists, with arbitrary outputs permitted when none exists. There is likewise no Borel decision procedure for membership in $E_{P_-}^{(1)}$.*

Proof. For a total Borel candidate f , testing $(S, f(S)) \in \mathcal{W}_{P_-}$ is Borel. Under the asserted correctness condition this test holds exactly on $E_{P_-}^{(1)}$, contradicting [theorem 6.3](#). The decision assertion is immediate. $\square$

This statement is deliberately about *total Borel* solvers. It neither rules out non-Borel choice functions nor claims that a partial procedure with a non-Borel domain is impossible.

6.6 Why colors will be necessary

Embeddability on $\mathcal{C}^{(1)}$ is Borel bireducible with embeddability of uncolored countable linear orders, allowing finite domains. In one direction use [theorem 5.1](#); in the other use the rational placement above. The known better-quasi-order behavior of countable linear orders prevents this from being a complete analytic quasiorder [7, 3]. Thus [theorem 6.3](#) is not a proof of quasiorder universality. The larger family $\mathcal{C}^\star$ supplies countably many intrinsically distinguishable Archimedean components, which removes this obstruction.

7 Quadratic colors and complete analytic embeddability

7.1 An explicit antichain of ordered divisible groups

For $n \in \mathbb{N}$, regard

$$H_n = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{p_n}) = \mathbb{Q} + \mathbb{Q}\sqrt{p_n}$$

as an ordered additive group. These groups are countable, divisible, and Archimedean.

Lemma 7.1 (Scalar rigidity). *If $H, H' \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ are additive subgroups with $1 \in H$, and $f : H \hookrightarrow H'$ is an ordered additive embedding, then $f(x) = \lambda x$ for every $x \in H$, where $\lambda = f(1) > 0$. For divisible subgroups the same proof is expressed with rational multiples; more generally integer comparisons suffice.*

Proof. For rational $r = m/n$ and $x \in H$, the inequality $r < x$ is equivalent to $m < nx$. After applying f , it is equivalent to $m\lambda < nf(x)$, or $r < f(x)/\lambda$. Hence x and $f(x)/\lambda$ have the same rational lower cut in $\mathbb{R}$, so they are equal. $\square$

This is the special case of Hion's lemma needed here; compare [3, Lemma 2.2].

Lemma 7.2 (Quadratic-color antichain). *An ordered additive embedding $H_n \hookrightarrow H_m$ exists if and only if $n = m$.*

Proof. Suppose $\lambda H_n \subseteq H_m$ is such an embedding by lemma 7.1. Since $\lambda = \lambda \cdot 1$ belongs to the field H_m and is nonzero, division by λ gives $H_n \subseteq H_m$. Both fields have degree two over $\mathbb{Q}$, so they are equal. Distinct prime quadratic fields are unequal: writing $\sqrt{p_n} = a + b\sqrt{p_m}$ with $a, b \in \mathbb{Q}$ and squaring forces $a = 0$ and $p_n/p_m = b^2$, which is impossible for distinct primes. The converse uses the identity map. $\square$

7.2 Putting a colored order into the fixed field

A countably colored linear order is a pair $L = (<_L, c_L)$ on $\mathbb{N}$, where $c_L : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$. Use the Borel rational placement e_L of its uncolored order, and define

$$A_L = \{(e_L(i), 1), (e_L(i), \sqrt{p_{c_L(i)}}) : i \in \mathbb{N}\}, \quad M_L = K_{A_L}. \quad (7.1)$$

At rank $e_L(i)$ the value group of M_L has Archimedean component $H_{c_L(i)}$. In particular, all fields M_L lie inside the same K^* ; the ambient field is not reconstructed for each input.

The map $L \mapsto A_L$ is Borel. For a given (q, b) , membership is a countable union of conditions involving $e_L(i) = q$ and one color value. Thus $L \mapsto M_L$ is Borel by theorem 4.3.

Theorem 7.3 (Exact colored-order coding). *For countably colored countable linear orders L, L' ,*

$$\begin{aligned} M_L \hookrightarrow M_{L'} &\iff L \hookrightarrow L' \text{ by an order- and color-preserving injection,} \\ M_L \cong M_{L'} &\iff L \cong L' \text{ as colored orders.} \end{aligned}$$

No color predicates are added to the field language.

Proof. Let $f : M_L \hookrightarrow M_{L'}$. Its value-group map induces an order embedding of rank chains, and hence an order injection $h : L \hookrightarrow L'$. At each rank, lemma 3.4 gives an ordered group embedding

$$H_{c_L(i)} \hookrightarrow H_{c_{L'}(h(i))}.$$

By lemma 7.2, the colors are equal. An isomorphism of fields makes the rank map an isomorphism.

Conversely, for a color-preserving order injection h , map the two independent generators at $e_L(i)$ to the corresponding two generators at $e_{L'}(h(i))$. For a finite monomial exponent, this relabels the rank coordinates while preserving the real coefficient within each coordinate. The order of exponents and the leading sign of every polynomial are therefore preserved. Algebraic independence gives an ordered embedding of the rational-function fields; real-closure uniqueness extends it to the required field embedding. A bijective h gives an isomorphism. $\square$

Theorem 7.4 (Complete analytic quasiorder in a closed subfield family). *Embeddability on C^* is a complete analytic quasiorder. Its associated bi-embeddability relation is a complete analytic equivalence relation. The hardness already holds on the Borel-coded fields M_L , all of which have transcendence degree $\aleph_0$ and residue field k .*

Proof. Embeddability is analytic by coding a map between countable fields and imposing the countable collection of field-table conditions. By [theorem 7.3](#), the Borel map $L \mapsto M_L$ reduces colored-order embeddability to it. Louveau’s completeness theorem for the former quasiorder [\[4, 3\]](#) proves the desired universality.

For bi-embeddability, let E be any analytic equivalence relation. As an analytic quasiorder it reduces to embeddability via a Borel map f . Symmetry of E then gives

$$xEy \iff f(x) \hookrightarrow f(y) \ \& \ f(y) \hookrightarrow f(x).$$

The converse follows from either embedding and the reduction property. Bi-embeddability is analytic, being the intersection of the two analytic embedding relations. Finally, each infinite-domain code [\(7.1\)](#) has countably infinitely many independent coordinates, so [\(3.1\)](#) and [theorem 3.3](#) give the stated invariants. $\square$

Together with [corollary 6.1](#) and [theorem 4.3](#), this proves [theorem 1.1](#). The novelty claim is limited: the broad universality theorem was known; the present proof places an explicit universal coding in a compact coordinate family of actual elementary subfields of a single specified countable surreal field.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** The write checked the cited statements of [\[3\]](#) (Lemma 2.2, Theorem 7.1, Proposition 7.2, Corollary 7.3; PDF pages 33–35 of version 2); they say what is attributed to them here. See [section 1.4](#).

8 The finite-transcendence-degree threshold

The finite-support argument imposes a sharp restriction on fixed-source existence questions even when the global embeddability quasiorder is maximally complicated.

Theorem 8.1 (Finite sources have finite-coordinate witnesses). *Let P be a real closed field of finite transcendence degree over its canonical copy of k . Then*

$$E_P^\star = \bigcup_{\substack{U \subseteq I \text{ finite} \\ P \hookrightarrow K_U}} \{A : U \subseteq A\}. \quad (8.1)$$

In particular $E_P^\star$ is an open upward-closed subset of 2^I . The same formula holds for the rank-one family with finite $U \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$.

Proof. Suppose $f : P \hookrightarrow K_A$. Choose a finite transcendence basis $a_1, \dots, a_d$ for P/k . Let

$$U = D(f(a_1)) \cup \dots \cup D(f(a_d)).$$

Then U is finite and contained in A . All $f(a_j)$ lie in K_U . Every element of $f(P)$ is algebraic over $k(f(a_1), \dots, f(a_d))$, and hence over K_U . Since K_U is real closed, it has no proper algebraic ordered extension inside $K^\star$. Therefore $f(P) \subseteq K_U$.

Conversely, any embedding into K_U composes with inclusion into K_A whenever $U \subseteq A$. Each upper cone on the right side of [\(8.1\)](#) is clopen, so the union is open. The rank-one argument is identical. When $d = 0$, the source is k and the witness is $U = \emptyset$. $\square$

Proposition 8.2 (Infinite sources have no interior). *If $\text{trdeg}_k P = \aleph_0$, both $E_P^\star$ and $E_P^{(1)}$ have empty interior. Thus, in either family, a nonempty fixed-source locus is open if and only if its source has finite transcendence degree.*

Proof. Finite subsets of the coordinate set are dense in its power set: every basic open cylinder only prescribes finitely many present and absent coordinates, and the required present coordinates alone give a finite member of the cylinder. By (3.1), no field from a finite coordinate set can contain an embedded copy of P . Every nonempty open set therefore meets the complement of the locus. Combine this with [theorem 8.1](#). $\square$

The nonempty qualification matters. A field not embeddable in the chosen ambient field has empty, hence open, locus regardless of its transcendence degree. We do not assert that $K^\star$ contains every countable real closed field; the fixed residue field alone precludes such a claim.

Example 8.3 (The simplest finite cases). If $U \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$ has $n < \omega$ elements, then

$$E_{K_U^{(1)}}^{(1)} = \{S : |S| \geq n\}.$$

Every n -element linear order is a chain, and it embeds into S exactly when S has at least n elements. For $n \geq 1$, the complement is the closed set of subsets of size at most $n - 1$.

Remark 8.4 (Open is not an effective claim). (8.1) does not furnish an algorithm deciding which finite U admit an embedding of an arbitrarily specified P . It proves a boldface topological fact: every positive instance has some finite coordinate neighborhood consisting entirely of positive instances. No uniform computability of the displayed union is claimed.

9 Generic collapse in the rank-one family

Equip $2^{\mathbb{Q}}$ with the product probability measure in which each rational is included independently with probability $1/2$. This choice is a measure on generator parameters, not on the surreal field.

Theorem 9.1 (A comeager conull isomorphism type). *The set*

$$\mathcal{G} = \{S \subseteq \mathbb{Q} : S \cap (a, b) \neq \emptyset \text{ for every } a < b \text{ in } \mathbb{Q}\}$$

is a dense G_δ of measure one. For every $S \in \mathcal{G}$, $K_S^{(1)} \cong K^{(1)}$. Consequently every nonempty $E_P^{(1)}$ contains $\mathcal{G}$ and is comeager and conull.

Proof. For fixed rational $a < b$, the condition of meeting (a, b) is open and dense: any finite cylinder can be extended by including a still unmentioned rational in that interval. It has probability one because $(a, b) \cap \mathbb{Q}$ is infinite, and the probability of missing its first m points is 2^{-m} . There are only countably many rational intervals, so their intersection is a dense G_δ of measure one.

Every $S \in \mathcal{G}$ is a countable dense linear order without endpoints. Cantor's back-and-forth theorem gives $S \cong \mathbb{Q}$. Now apply [theorem 5.1](#).

If $E_P^{(1)}$ is nonempty, then P embeds into some $K_T^{(1)} \subseteq K^{(1)}$. For $S \in \mathcal{G}$, composing with an isomorphism $K^{(1)} \cong K_S^{(1)}$ proves $S \in E_P^{(1)}$. $\square$

The last assertion also shows density, but there is a useful elementary version. A basic cylinder forbids only finitely many rationals, say V . The set $\mathbb{Q} \setminus V$ has order type $\mathbb{Q}$, meets that cylinder after respecting its required coordinates, and yields another copy of the ambient field.

Corollary 9.2 (Hardness concentrated on an exceptional set). *The analytic-complete set $E_{P_-}^{(1)}$ is comeager and conull. Its coanalytic-complete complement is meager and null. In particular, maximum analytic decision complexity can coexist with probability-one agreement on the answer.*

There is no conflict with [proposition 8.2](#): a comeager set may have empty interior. Indeed, every finite coordinate pattern can still be completed to a finite-rank field that does not admit P_- .

10 Two generic regimes in the universal family

The larger family $\mathcal{C}^*$ does not inherit the same generic collapse. Its additional coefficient coordinates can remove an entire Archimedean component type while leaving almost every rank active. This produces two opposite fixed-source phenomena within one compact space.

10.1 Dense loci and general zero–one laws

Use independent fair coin choices on the countable coordinate set $I = \mathbb{Q} \times B$. For $r \in \mathbb{Q}$, translation of the first coordinate gives

$$\tau_r(A) = \{(q + r, b) : (q, b) \in A\}.$$

The monomial relabeling $x_{q,b} \mapsto x_{q+r,b}$ extends to an isomorphism $K_A \cong K_{\tau_r(A)}$: it preserves the finite reverse-lexicographic exponent order. Thus each fixed-source locus E_P^* is invariant under all τ_r .

Theorem 10.1 (Density and zero–one laws). *For every countable real closed P , E_P^* is analytic. If it is nonempty, it is dense. It is either meager or comeager, and its product measure is either zero or one. The same zero–one laws hold for every translation-invariant analytic subset of 2^I .*

Proof. Analyticity follows from the closed witness relation in [section 6](#). Suppose $P \hookrightarrow K^*$, as holds whenever the locus is nonempty. In a basic cylinder let $V \subset I$ be the finite set of forbidden coordinates, and set $A = I \setminus V$. All columns at ranks outside the finite projection of V onto $\mathbb{Q}$ are complete. That cofinite rank set has order type $\mathbb{Q}$, so rank relabeling embeds K^* into K_A . Hence $P \hookrightarrow K_A$, and A lies in the cylinder. This proves density.

We prove the category statement for a translation-invariant set E with the Baire property, which every analytic set has. If E is nonmeager, it is comeager on some nonempty basic cylinder U . Given any other nonempty basic cylinder V , choose $r \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that the finitely many rank coordinates mentioned by $\tau_r(U)$ are disjoint from those mentioned by V . Then $\tau_r(U) \cap V$ is nonempty and open. Invariance makes E comeager on $\tau_r(U)$. If the complement of E were nonmeager, it would be comeager on some such V , contradicting the Baire theorem on their intersection. Therefore E is comeager.

For measure, analytic sets are measurable in the completion of the product measure. Approximate E in measure by a finite-coordinate event C , with $\mu(E \triangle C) < \varepsilon$. Choose a rational translation r making the rank coordinates of C and $\tau_r(C)$ disjoint. These two events are independent, so

$$\mu(C \cap \tau_r(C)) = \mu(C)^2.$$

Since $E = \tau_r(E)$, the symmetric difference between E and $C \cap \tau_r(C)$ has measure at most 2ε . Letting $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$ gives $\mu(E) = \mu(E)^2$, and hence $\mu(E) \in \{0, 1\}$. $\square$

The category and measure conclusions are separate dichotomies. The theorem does not say they agree for every source. The two explicit sources below do have matching category and measure behavior.

10.2 The reverse- ω source remains generically present

For $A \subset I$, let

$$J_A = \{q \in \mathbb{Q} : A_q \neq \emptyset\}, \quad A_q = \{b \in B : (q, b) \in A\}.$$

Proposition 10.2. *For $S \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$ and $A \subseteq I$,*

$$K_S^{(1)} \hookrightarrow K_A \iff (S, <) \hookrightarrow (J_A, <).$$

Consequently $E_{P_-}^$ is analytic-complete, comeager, and conull.*

Proof. Necessity follows from the intrinsic rank map. For sufficiency, take an order injection $h : S \hookrightarrow J_A$ and choose $b_q \in A_{h(q)}$ for each $q \in S$. Send t_q to $x_{h(q), b_q}$. Multiplication by the positive real b_q preserves the coefficient sign at the largest differing rank, so this map preserves signs of polynomials in the source generators. Algebraic independence and real-closure extension finish the embedding.

The face $S \mapsto S \times \{1\}$ continuously reduces $E_{P_-}^{(1)}$ to $E_{P_-}^*$, proving analytic-completeness. For each fixed q , the condition $A_q \neq \emptyset$ is open dense and has probability one, because B is infinite. The intersection over $q \in \mathbb{Q}$ is comeager and conull, and on it $J_A = \mathbb{Q}$. Every rank-one source embeds there, in particular P_- . $\square$

10.3 The whole ambient field is generically absent

Put $H = \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} B$. This is the Archimedean component of Γ_I at every rank.

Lemma 10.3 (A complete component cannot fit into a partial column). *For $C \subseteq B$, there is an ordered additive embedding*

$$H \hookrightarrow \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} C$$

if and only if $C = B$.

Proof. Let f be an embedding. By lemma 7.1, $f(x) = \lambda x$ with $\lambda = f(1) > 0$. Write

$$\lambda = a_0 + \sum_{i \in F} a_i \sqrt{p_i}, \quad a_i \in \mathbb{Q},$$

with F finite. Choose $j \notin F$. Since $\sqrt{p_j} \in H$,

$$\lambda \sqrt{p_j} = a_0 \sqrt{p_j} + \sum_{i \in F} a_i \sqrt{p_i p_j} \in \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} C \subseteq H.$$

Distinct squarefree radical monomials are independent by lemma 3.1. In particular, no nonzero coefficient of $\sqrt{p_i p_j}$ can occur in an element of H . Thus all a_i for $i \in F$ vanish, and $\lambda = a_0$ is a nonzero rational. Now $\lambda \cdot 1 \in \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} C$ forces $1 \in C$; and $\lambda \sqrt{p_n} \in \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}} C$ forces $\sqrt{p_n} \in C$ for every n . Therefore $C = B$. The converse is the identity embedding. $\square$

Define the complete-column rank set

$$D_A = \{q \in \mathbb{Q} : A_q = B\}.$$

Theorem 10.4 (Exact whole-ambient locus). *For $A \subseteq I$,*

$$K^\star \hookrightarrow K_A \iff (\mathbb{Q}, <) \hookrightarrow (D_A, <). \quad (10.1)$$

The locus $E_{K^\star}^\star$ is analytic-complete and dense, but meager and of measure zero. Its complement is coanalytic-complete.

Proof. If $K^\star \hookrightarrow K_A$, the rank map sends each source component H into the component at its image rank. By lemma 10.3, that target column must be complete. Thus the rank map embeds $\mathbb{Q}$ into D_A . Conversely, an order injection $h : \mathbb{Q} \hookrightarrow D_A$ permits the relabeling $x_{q,b} \mapsto x_{h(q),b}$ for every $b \in B$. This extends to an embedding of real closures and proves (10.1).

The locus is nonempty because $K^\star$ embeds into itself, and it is dense by theorem 10.1. For each q , the set $\{A : A_q = B\}$ is closed and nowhere dense: a finite cylinder can always be refined by omitting one as-yet unmentioned coordinate in that column. Its measure is zero, since the probability of including its first m coordinates is 2^{-m} . Therefore

$$\{A : D_A \neq \emptyset\} = \bigcup_{q \in \mathbb{Q}} \{A : A_q = B\}$$

is meager and null. The locus in (10.1) is a subset of this set, so it too is meager and null.

Finally, the map $S \mapsto S \times B$ is continuous and has $D_{S \times B} = S$. By (10.1) it reduces the analytic-complete set $\mathcal{N}$ of theorem 6.5 to $E_{K^\star}^\star$. Analyticity was already proved in theorem 10.1. This establishes analytic-completeness and the corresponding completeness of the complement. $\square$

Corollary 10.5 (Two infinite sources, opposite answers almost surely). *The infinite-transcendence-degree sources P_- and $K^\star$ both have dense embedding loci in $\mathcal{C}^\star$. The first locus is comeager and conull; the second is meager and null. Both are analytic-complete and both have empty interior.*

This proves the remaining clauses of theorem 1.2. It also shows that the finite-versus-infinite threshold controls *openness*, not probability. Infinite sources alone already exhibit both generic regimes.

11 Examples, diagnostic counterexamples, and interpretation

11.1 A two-scale calculation

For $q < r$, set $u = \omega^{\omega^q}$ and $v = \omega^{\omega^r}$. For every positive integer n ,

$$u^n = \omega^{n\omega^q} < \omega^{\omega^r} = v.$$

This is the field-level trace of the strict order between two Archimedean ranks in the value group. For a polynomial such as

$$P(u, v) = 3u^7v^2 - 5u^{100}v + 2u^3 - 9,$$

the v^2 term has the largest exponent regardless of the larger u exponent in the next term. Hence $P(u, v) > 0$. Replacing (q, r) by any increasing pair preserves the same comparison. This finite dominance is the mechanism behind the uncolored embeddings.

11.2 A color is a ratio type, not a named constant

At one rank q , the pair

$$\omega^{\omega^q}, \quad \omega^{\sqrt{2}\omega^q}$$

generates, after real closure, a component $\mathbb{Q} + \mathbb{Q}\sqrt{2}$. Replacing $\sqrt{2}$ by $\sqrt{3}$ gives a different ordered component. Although both are abstractly two-dimensional rational vector spaces, no order-preserving additive embedding exists between them. The source and target field languages contain neither a color predicate nor a distinguished value-group basis. The distinction survives because their ordered ratio structures are intrinsic to the fields' natural valuations.

11.3 Why finite rank cannot secretly code the fixed hard source

A finite coordinate set produces finite transcendence degree. It cannot contain an embedded copy of P_- , even if its generators have very large surreal birthdays or complicated real coefficients. Enlarging the complexity of finitely many terms is not the same as supplying infinitely many independent rank levels. This guards against an erroneous attempt to put the tree-hard fixed-source problem inside a finitely generated real closure.

11.4 What this does and does not say about algorithms

An analytic-completeness theorem is a non-Borel definability obstruction. It is stronger than failure of one proposed normal form, but it is not a numerical runtime lower bound and does not by itself prove a particular finite-input problem undecidable. Effective consequences require an explicit computable coding of field presentations and of the reductions. The present paper supplies Borel and continuous codings, not a full computable presentation of the surreal ambient field.

Conversely, the clopen membership tests in [theorem 4.3](#) show that the coding map itself is not the source of the descriptive difficulty. Individual elements require finitely many coordinates. It is the existential quantification over an entire embedding, and the infinite order structure that embedding must preserve, which creates the non-Borel locus.

12 Implications for mathematical evaluation and ProveIt

12.1 A sampling warning with a proof

The link to evaluation is a mathematical deduction, not an empirical claim about any particular benchmark. In the rank-one family, sampling each generator independently almost surely produces a field isomorphic to $K^{(1)}$. A test that merely answers “yes” to the fixed-source question for any $P \hookrightarrow K^{(1)}$ succeeds with probability one, even when its positive locus is analytic-complete. Such a test has not learned the exceptional structural cases.

In the full family, the reverse constant answer is almost surely correct for the source K^* : its embedding locus is null. Neither behavior is a satisfactory test of the exact equivalence in [theorems 5.1, 7.3 and 10.4](#). A structure-sensitive evaluation would deliberately include well-founded versus ill-founded tree codes, incompatible quadratic components, finite-transcendence-degree obstructions, and embeddings with nontrivial rank maps. Finite tree truncations alone do not certify an infinite branch, so they must not be mislabeled as tests of the full analytic existence theorem.

12.2 Repository snapshot and reusable boundaries

The repository inspected for this article was pinned to

7c0f2d9f92c3d51ec85703bed1022924a4b7359b.

The inspected surreal README distinguishes formal declarations from AI-assisted unrefereed reports [12]. Search and source inspection identified the following concrete integration points:

Repository path, relative to <code>Algebra/SurrealNumbers/</code>	Relevant boundary
<code>Surreal/Foundations/</code>	Real closedness of the actual
<code>SignSequenceRealClosed.lean</code>	sign-sequence surreal field.
<code>Surreal/HahnSeries/RealClosed.lean</code>	Set-sized ordered Hahn-field real
	closedness.
<code>SurrealAudit.lean</code>	Existing axiom-audit infrastructure.
<code>docs/surreal/</code>	Research background on rank, Hahn
<code>surreal-self-embeddings/README.md</code>	lifts, and size-safe foundations; not a
	formal proof of this article.

The declaration name `signSequenceIsRealClosed` occurs in the inspected foundation source. No claim is made that a build of the repository, or a kernel check of any new theorem here, was performed.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** At the write the three Lean files of the table are byte-identical to the pin, and the descriptions are accurate (section 1.4). The table’s paths are relative to `Algebra/SurrealNumbers/`. Beyond them, the only formal statement bearing on this report is the multiquadratic independence behind lemma 3.1 (note after that lemma); everything else here is unformalized, and the plan below remains a proposal.

12.3 A staged formalization plan

The most reusable theorem is theorem 4.1. It should be formalized first as a field-theoretic statement independent of surreal numbers. One needs an indexed algebraically independent family, a relative algebraicity predicate, finite character, and exchange. Its conclusion then gives continuity into the product of Boolean coordinates, arbitrary intersection formulas, and directed-union formulas.

A second stage treats finite-support ordered groups. For a linear order L and ordered Archimedean components H_l , use finitely supported functions with reverse-lexicographic order. Prove the rank computation and the induced maps on convex quotients. The quadratic-color obstruction is a finite algebraic subproject, separate from the higher descriptive complexity inputs.

A third stage constructs the coordinate monomial field and its relative real closure in a set-sized ordered real closed ambient field. The exact value group, residue field, and generator-relabeling maps provide the bridge to theorem 7.3. The surreal normal-form interface is needed only to instantiate the independent ordered monomial family.

Finally, implement the standard Borel spaces and the reductions. The analytic-completeness theorem for colored orders is a substantial external library dependency; it should either be proved, imported from an audited development, or left as an explicit hypothesis in a clearly named conditional theorem. Hiding it as an unexplained axiom would defeat the point of the proof boundary.

12.4 Finite verification included with this article

The accompanying Python program performs exact finite checks of reverse-lexicographic dominance, polynomial multiplication signs under increasing coordinate embeddings, finite-order embedding tests, quadratic radical character orthogonality, and the finite rational-placement algorithm. It uses rational and integer arithmetic, not floating-point surreal approximations. Its output records the seed and actual check counts.

These tests check implementation conventions and expose sign-orientation mistakes. They do not prove algebraic independence for infinitely many generators, the finite-support theorem, analytic completeness, or the category and measure theorems. Those are supported by the mathematical proofs and the stated external inputs.

13 Further research questions

The following questions are proposals for continued work. Their worldwide open status is not asserted. They are organized around gaps not settled by the present proofs, rather than restating the theorems already obtained.

Question 13.1 (Exact fixed-source complexity). For $P \hookrightarrow K^{(1)}$, classify the Borel or projective complexity of $E_P^{(1)}$. For sources of the form $K_S^{(1)}$, this becomes the complexity of $\{T : S \hookrightarrow T\}$. Determine which infinite source orders give Borel loci and which give analytic-complete loci. The present finite/infinite threshold decides openness, not this finer classification.

Question 13.2 (Generic isomorphism in the larger family). Determine the generic behavior of isomorphism on C^* . The ambient isomorphism class is meager and null by [theorem 10.4](#), so the rank-one collapse does not identify the generic type here. Is every isomorphism class meager or null? Which invariants describe independent random component subspaces $H_A(q)$?

Question 13.3 (Generic-presence criterion). Give an intrinsic criterion on a countable source $P \hookrightarrow K^*$ deciding whether E_P^* is comeager or meager. Is there a corresponding criterion in terms of the source's ordered value-group components and their finite supports? Do the category and measure alternatives always agree for these particular fixed-source loci?

Question 13.4 (Effective realization). Construct a uniform computable presentation of the rational monomial fields and their ordered real closures for suitable computable rank orders. Then determine the lightface complexity of the fixed-source problem. This requires controlling effective real-closure construction; the Borel proof alone is insufficient.

Question 13.5 (Canonical support computation). For an algebraic element specified by an isolating polynomial over the coordinate rational-function field, develop an algorithm computing its minimal support $D(a)$. Which operations permit efficient support cancellation tests? This is directly relevant to symbolic implementations and to a formal proof of the continuity theorem.

Question 13.6 (Quantitative birthday bounds). Find an explicit ordinal β containing the displayed K^* , ideally with a proof stable under real closure. Compare the birthday cost of this double-monomial realization with other realizations of the same ordered value groups. The existential set bound in [section 2](#) is not an optimality result.

Question 13.7 (How much compact localization is general?). For other model-complete theories with an algebraic closure pregeometry, identify sufficient conditions for a closed coordinate family of elementary submodels to support complete analytic embeddability. The finite-support lemma is general, but real closure and monomial order preservation supply additional structure that cannot simply be omitted.

Question 13.8 (Individual embeddings and automorphism groups). For a fixed rank-one or colored field, classify all embeddings inducing a prescribed rank map. Determine the kernel of the map from its automorphism group to automorphisms of the ordered component data, with the pointwise-convergence topology on the countable domain.

Question 13.9 (Additional named structure). What survives after naming selected generators, a monomial section, an integer part, or an appropriate restricted exponential operation? Naming all generators trivializes many maps, while exponential closure can destroy the independent-coordinate construction. A useful result would identify a nontrivial boundary between these extremes.

Question 13.10 (Invariant universality versus completeness). Does the embeddability quasiorder restricted to a suitably chosen Borel subfamily satisfy a stronger invariant-universality property compatible with isomorphism? [theorem 7.4](#) proves completeness only; the additional invariance requirements need a separate argument.

Question 13.11 (Changing the sampling law). Replace the fair coins by coordinate-dependent inclusion probabilities. Characterize when rank-one generic collapse persists, and when complete columns in the larger family appear with positive probability. Infinite products and interval-coverage conditions suggest explicit thresholds, but a full source-dependent theorem remains to be developed.

Question 13.12 (Proof-certified evaluation instances). Build a library of finite, checkable implications drawn from the source threshold, color incompatibility, and rank embeddings. Separate certificates for finite algebraic facts from assumptions about infinite trees, and measure whether a reasoning system respects that distinction. The goal is not to pretend that finite samples decide an analytic-complete set.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** The write found no report of the collection that answers any of these twelve questions. Related material: for [question 13.1](#), the note after [theorem 6.3](#) settles the source P_- on parameter families restricted to subsets of a fixed countable order, by `pma:bor:thm:dichotomy`; for [question 13.4](#), `foundations-and-computation/computable-surreals` gives effective countable real closed subfields of $\mathbf{No}$, but with value group $\mathbb{Q}$, not the families of ranks needed here; for [question 13.6](#), the collection's birthday reports (`foundations-and-computation/birthday-cutoffs-and-hereditary-sets`, `surreal/gonshor-product-birthdays`, `surreal/gonshor-laurent-birthdays`) are the places to look, but whether their bounds yield one for this β was not examined; for [question 13.8](#), `surreal/surreal-self-embeddings` studies embeddings of all of $\mathbf{No}$, not of these countable fields. The labels `csf:q:*` were added at the write.

14 Conclusion and claim status

A countable surreal field can contain a closed Cantor family whose membership coordinates are all clopen and whose embeddability quasiorder is analytically universal. The two facts coexist because finite support controls individual elements, whereas an embedding must preserve an infinite hierarchy of valuation ranks and components.

The rank-one subfamily gives an exact dictionary between field embeddings and order embeddings. It yields a fixed-source analytic-complete locus, an open-locus theorem for finite transcendence degree, and a probability-one isomorphism type. Adding quadratic coefficient colors both upgrades the quasiorder complexity and creates a contrasting source that is almost surely absent. The category and measure zero-one laws make this contrast structural rather than anecdotal.

The claims established here are proof-level refinements of known anti-classification machinery, not a claim to have first discovered the unrestricted complexity of real closed fields. The manuscript is an AI-assisted, unrefereed research draft. Its local theorems have detailed proofs; independent mathematical review and any future formalization remain separate validation steps.

A Proof-dependency ledger

Result	Mathematical dependencies	Status in this package
Double-monomial independence	Finite normal-form comparison; multiquadratic independence	Full proof, lemma 3.2 .
Exact values and residues	Natural valuation; minimum-term cancellation; real closedness of k	Full proof, theorem 3.3 .
Finite supports	Finite character and field exchange	Full proof, theorem 4.1 ; no surreal-specific hypothesis.
Cantor localization	Finite supports; compact-to-Hausdorff argument	Full proof, theorem 4.3 .
Rank-one classification	Intrinsic value-group rank; real-closure extension	Full proof, theorem 5.1 .
Fixed-source hardness	Rank classification; Kleene–Brouwer lemma; completeness of IF	New reduction proved in full; IF completeness credited.
Colored-order coding	Scalar rigidity; quadratic antichain; intrinsic components	Full proof, theorem 7.3 .
Complete analytic quasiorder	Colored-order coding; Louveau’s theorem	Coding proved; external completeness input explicit.
Finite-source threshold	Finite supports; algebraicity of source over a finite basis	Full proof, theorem 8.1 and proposition 8.2 .
Generic collapse	Rational interval coverage; countable dense-order back-and-forth	Full proof, theorem 9.1 .
Zero–one laws	Translation symmetry; Baire property; finite-cylinder measure approximation	Full proof, theorem 10.1 .
Rare whole-ambient embeddings	Radical independence; component map; integer-sum tree transform; countable null union	Full proof, theorem 10.4 .
Lean verification	Would require newly implemented statements and a kernel run	Not supplied or claimed.

B Finite checks and reproducibility

The archive contains `article.tex`, `article.pdf`, a short README, a source-and-claim audit, and the following small reproducibility assets:

<code>code/finite_checks.py</code>	Standard-library exact finite checks.
<code>data/finite_checks.json</code>	Recorded output of the delivered run.
<code>build.sh</code>	Repeats the checks and compiles the article.
<code>SHA256SUMS.txt</code>	Checksums of the delivered files.

Run from the package directory:

```
python3 code/finite_checks.py --output data/finite_checks.json
pdflatex -interaction=nonstopmode -halt-on-error article.tex
pdflatex -interaction=nonstopmode -halt-on-error article.tex
pdflatex -interaction=nonstopmode -halt-on-error article.tex
```

No font files, external data downloads, or nonstandard Python packages are required. A normal TeX Live installation with the packages named in the preamble is sufficient.

The finite polynomial representation stores exponent vectors in increasing rank-coordinate order, so the largest index is the most significant one. After combining equal monomials, the leading coefficient determines the sign. Products are formed by exact convolution, including cancellation, and checked against the ordered-field sign law and monotone reindexing. The rational-placement tests enumerate finite orders and use exact fractions. Radical checks implement independent sign characters, rather than numerical approximations to square roots.

The recorded checks are deliberately modest evidence. A passed finite test cannot certify the non-Borel conclusions, and no such interpretation of `finite_checks.json` should be made.

[write] **Added 4 October 2026, batch 90.** In ProveIt the package is laid out differently. The archive's `article.pdf`, `README` and `SHA256SUMS.txt` are not shipped (the checksums were verified at placement; the PDF is replaced by a build of this text, the `README` by a report `README`); the source audit is `SOURCE_AND_CLAIM_AUDIT.md`; `build.sh` is shipped as `code/build.sh`, where its change to its own directory makes it look for `code/code/finite_checks.py` and `code/article.tex`, so it must be run on a copy in the delivered layout. Run in place with `-output data/finite_checks.json`, the checks would overwrite the recorded file; write to a scratch path instead. At the write a rerun on a copy (Python 3.14.4) passed all 25,378 checks and reproduced `data/finite_checks.json` except for the `python_version` line (the recorded run used 3.13.5); on Windows the output has CRLF line ends. The report `README` gives the commands, and the archive can be recovered with `git show a162e4386:docs/incoming/Surreal_Subfield_Cantor_Research.zip`.

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- [13] *Self-Embeddings of the Surreal Numbers*. Merged AI-assisted research report in *ProveIt*, at the same snapshot as [12]. Directory `Algebra/SurrealNumbers/docs/surreal/surreal-self-embeddings/`. Its README explicitly distinguishes the report from formalized results.